

ANCHORED BY DISCERNMENT

Therefore give to Your servant an understanding heart to judge
Your people, that I may discern between good and evil. For who is
able to judge this great people of Yours? (1 Kings 3:9)

FOR FAMILY WORSHIP: Pages 30-32

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THE ULTIMATE REQUEST

The throne room is dark, but Solomon is still awake. Outside, thousands of people are sleeping, trusting their new king to know what to do when morning comes. But Solomon knows something they do not know: he does not feel ready.

He can almost see tomorrow waiting for him. A mother may come crying for justice. A soldier may ask for orders. Leaders may disagree, and people will expect answers. Solomon could ask God for power, fame, victory, riches, or applause. Instead, the young king whispers a prayer that sounds small, but changes everything: "Give me an understanding heart."

The Bible says, "Therefore give to Your servant an understanding heart to judge Your people, that I may discern between good and evil" (1 Kings 3:9). Solomon is not asking for a louder voice or a bigger crown. He is asking God to help his heart

see clearly. He knows some choices are not easy, because fear, feelings, pressure, and many voices can make the right path hard to find.

Discernment means letting God to guide us in knowing what is true, good, and wise. For a child, we could say it this way: discernment is like having a little light from God inside your heart. When something looks fun, shiny, or popular, God's light helps you ask, "Is this good for me? Is this kind? Is this true? Will this help me love God and others?"

We need that kind of light today. Screens flash. Friends post. Videos shout for our attention. In a **VUCA WORLD**, where things change fast and answers feel unclear, we do not need more noise. We need God's wisdom.

So today, let's pray like Solomon. Lord, help us pause before we choose, listen before we follow, and look deeper before we believe. The world may be loud, but God can teach us to see clearly, one choice, one screen, and one quiet prayer at a time.

FAMILY PRAYER

Place one hand on your forehead, one on your heart, and pray: **"God, give us discernment; let the Holy Spirit help us see clearly. In Jesus' name, amen."**

When becoming king, Solomon's world was like:

VOLATILE: The kingdom was changing fast.

UNCERTAIN: A young king led many.

COMPLEX: Hard choices could change lives.

AMBIGUOUS: Both answers seemed almost right.

Although with God's help, we can turn it into:

VENTURE: Courage to ask for wisdom.

UNVEIL: Eyes open to what matters.

COMPASS: A heart that sees clearly.

ASSURANCE: Choices shaped by love.

Remember: Solomon faced big choices, but he did not face them alone. In a **VUCA WORLD**, discernment helps us slow down, listen to God, and choose with a clear heart.

1 Read
1 Kings 3:9
together

2 Underline
the word
"**discern**"

3 Ask yourself:

- Do I mistake feelings for truth?
- Do screens shape what I want?

Solomon's story helps us learn that wisdom is not just knowing many things, but seeing what is good and true. **I promise we will ask God together for clear eyes, so our family can choose what builds love, rest, and character.**

FAMILY ACTIVITY: The Wise Choice Jar

Place a jar on the table and give each person a small piece of paper. Ask everyone to write or draw a screen choice that could help the family, like "no phones at dinner" or "screens off before bed." Put the papers in the jar. Then take turns pulling one out, reading it, and asking: **"Does this protect our love, our rest, or our relationship with God?"**



**FURTHER STUDY
FOR PARENTS:**

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Today's Principle:
Awareness of Reality

Today's promise for your home is wise and discerning:
God can help your family pause, see what is true, and choose what is good.

Parenting in a noisy world can feel overwhelming, but Solomon's prayer gives your home a better path. This section helps you slow down, see what screens are teaching, and guide your children toward wisdom, rather than just more rules or information.

V VENTURE BEYOND FEAR IN A VOLATILE WORLD

A volatile world changes quickly, and a home can feel the same. One message, one video, one argument, or one worried thought can pull the whole family into a reactive state. Solomon reminds parents that courage does not begin with having all the answers. Courage begins with asking God to help us see clearly.

Solomon did not ask God for success, attention, or control. He asked for discernment. Discernment means learning to see the difference between what only looks good and what is truly good. Even a child can understand it this way: wisdom helps us choose the better path when two paths seem shiny.

For parents, this matters deeply. Screens move fast, emotions rise fast, and pressure speaks loudly. But God can give you a clear heart.

ASK YOURSELF TODAY: AM I SEEING REALITY, OR AM I ONLY REACTING TO WHAT GRABS MY ATTENTION?

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UNVEIL DEEPER TRUTH IN UNCERTAIN TIMES

Solomon teaches us that wisdom is not just having all the answers. Wisdom is learning to tell the difference between what catches our attention and what is truly good for our hearts, our homes, and our walk with God.

Read 1 Kings 3:9 quietly and underline the word discern. Then ask: Do I know the difference between what looks attractive and what is right? Do strong feelings ever make something seem true? Are screens shaping what I want? Am I building good judgment, or am I just collecting more information?

IN UNCERTAIN TIMES, FAMILIES NEED A CLEAR HEART THAT CAN PAUSE, LISTEN TO GOD, AND CHOOSE WHAT IS RIGHT.

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COMPASS THAT REMAINS STEADY THROUGH COMPLEXITY

Today's promise is hopeful and clear: God can help your family see what is true, choose what is good, and use screens with wisdom.

Awareness of reality means learning to see clearly. The educational principles outlined by Ellen White remind us that education is not only about giving children information. It is about helping them grow into people who can think, choose, and follow God with understanding. Ellen G. White wrote, ***"It is the work of true education... to train the youth to be thinkers, and not mere reflectors of other men's thought"*** (Education, p. 17.2).

That is discernment. Discernment is the ability to pause and ask, "Is this true? Is this helpful? What is this teaching my heart? Is this moving our family closer to the people God is calling us to become?" A child can understand it this way: discernment is like using the light God gives us to see the difference between a shiny wrapper and good food.

For busy parents, this can begin in small moments. After a video, during dinner, or in the car, ask, "How did that make you feel?" "Why do you think people like this?" "What kind of person is this teaching us to become?"

This is not about treating technology as the enemy. It is about teaching your child to read the digital world with open eyes. Some content entertains. Some shapes emotions. Some build character, and some pull the heart away from rest, kindness, truth, or identity.

A child who understands why a choice is wise becomes stronger than a child who only obeys because of fear.

WISDOM IS SEEING CLEARLY ENOUGH TO CHOOSE WHAT HELPS LOVE, TRUTH, AND CHARACTER GROW AT HOME TODAY.

A ASSURANCE THAT STANDS FIRM AMID AMBIGUITY

This week, before you invite the whole family into a screen agreement, begin with a quiet parent moment called the **TWO-CHAIR WISDOM CHECK**. Sit together after the children are asleep, or during a calm moment, and talk about one screen habit your home needs right now. Maybe your family needs more loving conversation, better rest, or a stronger reminder that you belong to God.

Then each parent writes a screen rule and its reason. For example: “No phones at the table, because dinner is for listening and loving.” Or, “Screens off 30 minutes before bedtime, because our minds and bodies need rest.” Or, “We will review what we watch, because we want choices that help us remember we belong to God.” Compare your answers. Ask, “Are we trying to stop trouble, or teach wisdom?” Choose a rule you can both model first, then share it with your children.

ASK: IS THIS RULE GROWING FROM FEAR, OR FROM A DESIRE TO GUIDE CHILDREN WISELY?



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Solomon chose discernment over power. Families do not need more screens; they need clearer judgment. In a **VUCA WORLD**, wisdom helps hearts see what is true, good, and worth following.